

BEYOND BGMI

KRAFTON'S INDIA GAMING PLAYBOOK EXPLAINED

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CEO, Krafton India

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Krafton's India story has stopped being a "BGMI-only" headline and turned into a broader, longer game. In December 2025, the company partnered with Naver and Mirae Asset to set up an India-focused fund (pegged up to ₹6,000 crore) aimed at backing growth-stage firms, with India positioned as a central priority.

At the same time, Krafton has been putting real chips on the table inside gaming itself, acquiring a controlling stake in Nautilus Mobile (the Real Cricket franchise) in March 2025, signalling a deeper push into India-origin game development rather than only importing proven global IP.

Add to that BGMI's post-ban comeback and you get the context for why every Krafton conversation in India now naturally expands into esports, regulation, talent, and what "gaming as culture" looks like here. In my exclusive conversation with Sean Hyunil Sohn, CEO, Krafton India, I got the feeling that Krafton isn't just talking the talk, they're very much walking the walk, showcasing

the scale of their ambition for Indian gaming. Edited excerpts of my interview follows:

Krafton India Awards. What's the reason behind doing this?

Sean Sohn: I think, basically, we want to show our appreciation to the partners who are supporting us and who have been, in a way, living this journey with us for quite a few years now. At an individual level, obviously, we've been talking to them, but there was no occasion where we showed that publicly. So I think that idea has been there for a couple of years, but now we have the bandwidth to make it happen, and there has been a lot of effort from our team members to make it possible.

Speaking of sizable things, what's the vision behind the ₹6,000 crore fund?

Sean Sohn: I think there are mainly two reasons. First, we have been investing – now we have invested \$200 million over the last three to four years in Indian gaming. And I think some of our preferred companies have seen quite a lot of growth, and some of them are now preparing for an IPO, etc. But I think we still felt a bandwidth issue. We have our own investment team, but India is a big country, and there are a lot of industries that we don't properly cover as a gaming company or a digital entertainment company.

So we decided to partner with financial institutions like Mirae Asset, which has a strong presence in India.